

MY INTERNSHIP @ XERFI

A deep dive into economic research & business intelligence



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ABOUT XERFI

FOUNDED

1993 — Paris, France

SECTOR

Private Economic Research & Business Intelligence

EMPLOYEES

~300 analysts & researchers

CLIENTS

20,000+ companies & institutions across France

Sector Studies

Market Analysis

Economic Forecasts

Strategic Intelligence

Xerfi Canal

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Xerfi is France’s leading independent business research firm — producing thousands of sector reports and economic outlooks every year.

WHO I REPORTED TO

NAME

Romain Lorenzi

TITLE / ROLE

Data Engineer / Project Manager

DEPARTMENT

I.T. / Data

→ French Engineer

→ ~10 years experience in data & project management

→ In the company for ~2 years

WHAT I WORKED ON

MAIN OBJECTIVES

KEY PROJECT

PROJECT NAME

Press articles scraping

TYPE

Internal project

Web scraping

Data cleaning

Data visualisation

Databases

WHAT I WORKED ON

MAIN OBJECTIVES

→ Web Scraper

KEY PROJECT

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Press articles scraping

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Internal project

- Web scraping
- Data cleaning
- Data visualisation
- Databases

WHAT I WORKED ON

MAIN OBJECTIVES

- Web Scraper
- Data cleaning and processing

Web scraping

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Web scraping

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THE EXPERIENCE

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LOGISTICS

On site

9am–5pm

THE EXPERIENCE

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TYPICAL DAY

Work 9am–12pm / 1pm–5pm
Lunch with colleagues

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TEAM

Two interns and a data Engineer

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Two interns and a data Engineer

TRADITIONS

Christmas Events, "Galette des Rois"

RISING TO THE OCCASION

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THE STAKES

Broken tool, technology switch

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THE STAKES

Broken tool, technology switch

MY RESPONSE

- From Python to WebApp development
- Adapted to our objectives

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THE STAKES

Broken tool, technology switch

MY RESPONSE

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PRIOR EXPERIENCE THAT HELPED

- Previous web experience
- Web classes at Polytech

WHAT I GAINED

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RESULT

Working project, active scraper

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Python & Web
development

WHAT I GAINED

RESULT

Working project, active scraper



Python & Web
development



Weekly reports

WHAT I GAINED

RESULT

Working project, active scraper



Python & Web
development



Weekly reports



Industry usage of AI

WHAT I GAINED

RESULT

Working project, active scraper



Python & Web
development



Weekly reports



Industry usage of AI



Information seeking

LOOKING BACK

WHAT WORKED WELL

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

LOOKING BACK

WHAT WORKED WELL

→ Active information research

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

LOOKING BACK

WHAT WORKED WELL

- Active information research
- Good communication

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

LOOKING BACK

WHAT WORKED WELL

- Active information research
- Good communication
- Effective time management

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WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

- Too much usage of AI for coding

LOOKING BACK

WHAT WORKED WELL

- Active information research
- Good communication
- Effective time management

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

- Too much usage of AI for coding
- Work in another IT field

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An interesting experience overall, with a good balance of autonomy and support.

LOOKING BACK

WHAT WORKED WELL

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- Good communication
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WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

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NEXT STEPS

An internship in a greater organization